

Uluru-Kata Tjuṯa, Northern Territory

Red Centre, NT, Australia

UNESCO Dual World Heritage Site

Last updated: May 2026

UNESCO status

Dual World Heritage — natural & cultural

Destination health

Good — effectively managed

Climbing

Permanently banned — Oct 2019

NT minimum wage

AUD \$24.10 / hr

i Destination overview

Location & size

1,325 km² national park in the Red Centre, 450 km southwest of Alice Springs. Uluru rises 348m above the desert plain; Kata Tjuta's highest dome (Mount Olga) reaches 546m.

Access

Ayers Rock Airport (AYQ) at Yulara — direct flights from Sydney, Melbourne, Brisbane, Cairns and Alice Springs. All visitors pass through Yulara (Ayers Rock Resort), the sole tourism hub.

Best season

May–September (cool, dry). Avoid November–March (extreme heat up to 50°C; walks close above 36°C).

Governing body

Parks Australia (Director of National Parks) in joint management with Anangu Traditional Owners via the Uluru-Kata Tjuṯa Board of Management. The land is Aboriginal freehold title, leased to the Director of National Parks.

Key legal frameworks

EPBC Act 1999 · Aboriginal Land Rights (NT) Act 1976 · Uluru-Kata Tjuta National Park Management Plan · EPBC Regulations 2025

Park entry fee

AUD \$38 per adult (valid 3 days). All tour operators must hold a valid commercial operations permit.

♥ Anangu Traditional Owners & Tjukurpa

This is the defining consideration at Uluru. Cultural sensitivity here is not a supplementary concern — it is the entire framework within which tourism operates. Every guide, sales conversation and itinerary must reflect this.

Traditional Owners

The Anangu are the Aboriginal custodians of Uluru-Kata Tjuṯa. They have lived on and cared for this Country for at least 60,000 years. The handback of the park to Anangu ownership occurred on 26 October 1985 — marking its 40th anniversary in October 2025.

Tjukurpa

Tjukurpa is the Anangu system of law, knowledge, creation stories and moral code — a living reality, not historical — that governs how the land is understood, managed and cared for. Every physical feature of Uluru and Kata Tjuta is connected to Tjukurpa.

Gender-restricted sites

Several areas are restricted by Anangu law to either men or women only. These restrictions must be strictly honoured and communicated clearly to all visitors before arrival.

Sorry Business

The park may close fully or partially following the death of a senior Anangu person. Orange Journeys must check park status at uluru.gov.au before any group departure and include a contingency clause in client documentation.

Correct naming

Always use "Uluru" — not "Ayers Rock" — in all client communications and marketing. Similarly use "Kata Tjuta" rather than "The Olgas". This is a basic act of respect and recognition of Traditional Ownership.

! Climbing ban & restricted areas

ABSOLUTE PROHIBITION

Climbing Uluru has been permanently prohibited since 26 October 2019. The climb route crosses a sacred men's ceremonial track connected to the Mala Tjukurpa. This is a legal prohibition under park regulations. Any contracted operator offering or suggesting the climb must be immediately removed from Orange Journeys' supplier list. This must be communicated to all clients before departure without exception.

Rock formations

Visitors must not climb onto any rock formations or boulders anywhere in the park. All must stay on marked tracks at all times.

Restricted zones

Certain caves, fissures, waterholes and features at both Uluru and Kata Tjuta are restricted. Clearly signposted. When in doubt, do not enter and ask a ranger.

📷 Photography rules

Critical for sales and guide briefings: Photography at Uluru is subject to strict rules. Violations are a legal offence and cause genuine cultural harm to the Anangu. This must be communicated to every client before arrival.

No-photography zones

Specific areas of Uluru and Kata Tjuta are permanently prohibited from photography. Marked with "no photography" signs. The rock features in these zones are equivalent to sacred scripture — photographing them degrades Anangu culture. Signs are a legal directive, not a suggestion.

Photographing Anangu

Always seek explicit permission before photographing Anangu people. Under Tjukurpa, Anangu honour their dead by not displaying images of deceased persons — permission must be sought each time images are published.

Commercial photography

Any commercial photography or filming requires a permit from Parks Australia and cultural consultation with Anangu. Orange Journeys must obtain this permit before any promotional shoot.

🌿 Biodiversity & natural environment

Ecosystem

Part of the Greater Sandy Desert bioregion — one of only five reserves where less than 5% of total area is protected. Traditional fire management by Anangu is the primary conservation tool.

Key wildlife

178 bird species · 83 reptile species (including the perentie, second largest goanna in the world) · 21 threatened mammal species

Mala (rufous hare-wallaby)

Critically endangered — reintroduced

Itjaritjari (marsupial mole)

Endangered — EPBC listed

Murtja (mulgara)

Vulnerable — EPBC listed

Ngintaka (perentie)

Protected — cultural significance

Scarlet-chested parrot

Endangered — rare sighting

11 migratory bird species

Listed under international conventions

Conservation threats

Climate change — increasing wildfire risk · Invasive species (feral cats, camels, buffel grass) · 5 mammal species locally extinct since 1970

✓ Visitor code of conduct

DO

- ✓ Use the name "Uluru", not "Ayers Rock"
- ✓ Stay on all marked tracks and paths
- ✓ Check and respect all no-photography signs
- ✓ Ask permission before photographing Anangu
- ✓ Carry and drink plenty of water (min. 1L/hr)
- ✓ Wear a hat and sun protection at all times
- ✓ Check park open/close times before each day
- ✓ Visit the Cultural Centre to understand Tjukurpa
- ✓ Purchase art directly from Anangu-owned outlets
- ✓ Observe all park closures (Sorry Business, weather)

DO NOT

- ✗ Climb Uluru or any rock formation — illegal
- ✗ Enter or photograph restricted/sacred sites
- ✗ Remove any rock, sand, soil or plant material
- ✗ Approach or disturb wildlife
- ✗ Enter the Mutitjulu community — closed to visitors
- ✗ Photograph Anangu without explicit permission
- ✗ Use images of sacred sites in any publication
- ✗ Litter anywhere in the park
- ✗ Walk alone — always with a guide or group
- ✗ Attempt walks in extreme heat (above 36°C)

Health & safety note: Heat-related illness is a genuine risk. Walks close automatically above 36°C. Nearest hospital is Alice Springs — 450 km away. Ensure all clients have travel insurance with medical evacuation cover.

🏘 Local economic network & preferred operators

Anangu-owned Uluru-Kata Tjuta Cultural Centre tours — Anangu-owned and operated guided tours. The only tours led directly by Traditional Owners.
Cultural Centre · Book via Parks Australia

Anangu-led SEIT Outback Australia — Patji Tour: exclusive access to restricted areas of the Red Centre, guided by Anangu Traditional Owners themselves. Frequently sells out.
Yulara-based · Small groups · High cultural immersion

Cultural Walkatjara Art Centre — meet Anangu artists, learn dot painting overlooking Uluru, hear Tjukurpa stories. Art purchases directly support Anangu artists and community.
Ayers Rock Resort · Anangu artist employment

Cultural Maruku Arts — dot painting workshops and Anangu-made craft. All proceeds go to Anangu artists.
Cultural Centre · Anangu-run

Ranger-guided Parks Australia ranger activities — daily ranger-guided walks (Mala Walk, Kuniya Walk) with Anangu cultural interpretation. Free with park entry.
Departures from Cultural Centre · Check [uluru.gov.au](https://www.parksaustralia.gov.au) for schedule

Client encouragement

Encourage clients to purchase art and souvenirs exclusively from Anangu-owned outlets rather than resort gift shops. Only 7% of Ayers Rock Resort's workforce is Anangu — spending with Anangu operators makes a direct difference.

Donation opportunities

Uluru-Kata Tjuta National Park Foundation · Anangu community programs via Parks Australia · Bush Heritage Australia (Red Centre conservation)

\$ Labour standards & wages

NT / National minimum wage (FY2024-25)

AUD \$24.10 per hour

Tourism & hospitality award

Check Fair Work Australia for role-specific rates

Context note

When selecting operators, prioritise those with demonstrated Anangu employment and economic benefit. Ask operators directly about their Anangu employment percentage before contracting.

↑ Orange Journeys engagement & policy influencing

Relevant bodies

Parks Australia · Uluru-Kata Tjuta Board of Management · Tourism NT · Voyages Indigenous Tourism Australia · Northern Land Council

Conservation contribution

Recommended: allocate a per-booking contribution from Uluru packages to Anangu community programs via Parks Australia or Bush Heritage Australia's Red Centre work.

Positive story for clients: The mala (rufous hare-wallaby) was saved from extinction through a partnership between Anangu traditional knowledge and modern conservation science — a powerful example of why Indigenous custodianship matters.

Sources: Parks Australia / uluru.gov.au · UNESCO World Heritage Centre · IUCN World Heritage Outlook 2025 · DCCEEW Natural Environment assessment · Tourism Australia (Uluru Handback 40th Anniversary, Oct 2025) · Discover Aboriginal Experiences portfolio · Fair Work Australia. Park closure status must be verified at uluru.gov.au before every group departure. Prepared by Orange Journeys sustainability team.